Chapter 5

Travelling and Sending Messages

Long ago, people walked or used animals such as horses, camels and bullocks to travel from one place to another. Today, we have many faster means of transport.

Means of transport

- Land: bicycles, bullock carts, buses, cars, trucks and trains.
- Water: boats and ships.
- Air: aeroplanes and helicopters.

Roads join villages to towns and cities. Trucks carry vegetables, fruits and other goods from one place to another along the roads.

Railways

Trains can carry many people and heavy goods over long distances at a low cost. The first passenger train in India ran on 16 April 1853, from Bombay (now Mumbai) to Thane. Today, the railways join almost every part of the country.

Ships and aeroplanes

Big ships carry goods across the seas to other countries. Ports such as Mumbai, Kolkata and Chennai are places where ships load and unload goods.

Aeroplanes are the fastest means of transport. They are useful for going to faraway places quickly, but travelling by air costs a lot of money.

Sending messages

Sending and receiving messages is called communication. Long ago, kings sent messages with messengers on horses, and some people even trained pigeons to carry messages.

Today, we can send messages in many ways.

- Letters and parcels are sent through the post office.
- We can talk to people far away on the telephone and the mobile phone.
- We can send e-mails and messages through the internet in a few seconds.

Mass communication

Newspapers, radio and television carry news to millions of people at the same time. This is called mass communication.

Road safety

- Always walk on the footpath.
- Cross the road at the zebra crossing. Look to the right, then to the left, and then to the right again before crossing.
- Wear a helmet when riding a two-wheeler and a seat belt in a car.

Let's think

1. Name two means of transport each for land, water and air.
2. When did the first passenger train run in India?
3. What is mass communication?

New words

transport - ways of carrying people and goods from one place to another
communication - sending and receiving messages